themselves which shall appear desirous and capable of maintaining friendly relations with the neighbouring states.'[109]

In reality, however, Ellenborough believed there was only one man who could restore order in Afghanistan. At the same time as the Simla Proclamation was issued, Amir Dost Mohammad was quietly released from house arrest in Mussoorie. 'The Amir held a feast for all and sundry to celebrate, before leaving for Ferozepur,' wrote Mirza 'Ata.

> There he had an audience with the Governor General and took his leave, accompanied by an official escort of 500 cavalry and foot-soldiers, as well as elephants, camels and bullock-carts to carry baggage. Haidar Khan, the Amir's son [who had been captured during the taking of Ghazni] and Haji Khan Kakar [who had delayed Outram's search party and given the Amir time to escape to Bukhara] were all sent to Ludhiana to join the Amir's entourage. After two months the Amir and his party left for Afghanistan; Lord Ellenborough granted him a rich cloak of honour, and sat in private session with him for a whole watch, urging him never to cross or confront the English government, and to maintain peaceful relations with the Sikhs and to refrain from hostilities. He advised that the Amir should restrain his son, Akbar Khan. Then they parted, and the Governor General ordered that the Amir's daily allowance should be paid until he entered the Khyber.[110]

The second retreat from Kabul began peacefully enough.

The long lines of soldiers, refugees and camp followers passed down the Khord Kabul and Tezin passes with barely a shot being fired. It was only when they neared the eastern Ghilzai heartlands just before Jagdalak that the sniping began.

It was Neville Chamberlain's fate to bring up the end of the column:

> I was walking in rear of all with my orderly, rifle in hand, taking shots at the rascals, when my orderly's horse, from which I had been firing, was riddled through the neck. I had not gone many paces when I was struck myself. I spun around and fell to the ground, but soon got up again and staggered on in great pain. I was determined that the Affghans should not even have the satisfaction of thinking they had done for me. On putting my hand on my back I thought it was all over with me, but on getting into camp we found the ball had not penetrated the skin, and it tumbled out on the doctor touching it.[111]

Others were less lucky. Chamberlain recorded how in an echo of the first retreat, the camp followers and refugees were now beginning to fall by the roadside. There they had to be left 'to be murdered by the Ghilzai, we not having any means of conveying them. I have myself given my own charger and made the men dismount to bring on the poor creatures, but after they